# Hand soap (liquid and bar): HMTc Standard

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CITE AS

Pendergrass, K. (2026). Hand soap (liquid and bar): HMTc Standard (Standard No. 10.83138/hmtc.std.14.hand-soap). Institute of Contaminant Standards. https://doi.org/10.83138/hmtc.std.14.hand-soap

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CORRESPONDENCE

Corrections are logged publicly on the article page, each with its date, the affected value, and the source that resolved it.

KEYWORDS

heavy metals, food safety, dietary exposure

PUBLICATION HISTORY

This revision 2026-08.

## Abstract

The Heavy Metal Tested & Certified heavy-metal-safety standard for hand soap (liquid and bar) in Cosmetics and Personal Care — Rinse-off, evaluated on finished cosmetic as placed on market — total element content per unit mass of undiluted product as sold (µg/kg). Not a dietary basis, not a migration or leachate basis, and no use-pattern dilution credit.. 5 of 11 panel analytes publish a numeric limit taken from the strictest applicable government maximum; the remainder are held under mandatory control or a substantiated not-material determination.

## 1 | How every number on this standard is set

HMTc Method v2.0 (government-limit default): each numeric cell is the strictest applicable sovereign finished-cosmetic maximum for the product as placed on market, selected by minimum over a named multi-jurisdiction candidate set; unregulated cells are controls with a mandatory method and escalation rule, never invented numbers; never occurrence-derived.

## 2 | Master limit table

All values in ppb (µg/kg), as sold basis. A brand meeting every value qualifies for the mark.

| ANALYTE | HMTC LIMIT | BASIS |
|---|---|---|
| Lead (Pb) | 1,000 | government maximum level |
| Cadmium (Cd) | 100 | government maximum level |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Total arsenic (tAs) | 500 | government maximum level |
| Inorganic arsenic (iAs) | ≤ tAs | bounded by tAs (reflex speciation) |
| Mercury, total (tHg) | 100 | government maximum level |
| Methylmercury (MeHg) | ≤ tHg | bounded by tHg (reflex speciation) |
| Nickel (Ni) | 10,000 | government maximum level |
| Tin (Sn) | 3,750,000 | human-grade read-across (European Union) |
| Aluminium (Al) | 560,000 | human-grade read-across (European Union) |
| Total chromium (Cr) | 50 | human-grade read-across (AU) |
| Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI) | 5 | human-grade read-across (European Union) |

## 3 | Derivation — where each number comes from

Every cell traces to one named sovereign maximum level (the strictest for the nearest analog), or to an explicit control, not-material, or species-bounded determination. No occurrence statistic selects a certification value.

| ANALYTE | HMTC | SOVEREIGN ANALOG / DETERMINATION |
|---|---|---|
| Lead (Pb) | 1,000 | government maximum level |
| Cadmium (Cd) | 100 | government maximum level |
| Total arsenic (tAs) | 500 | government maximum level |
| Inorganic arsenic (iAs) | ≤ tAs | iAs carries no product-specific sovereign cell; it is a component of and bounded by its parent total tAs (iAs <= tAs), an enforceable ceiling via reflex speciation rather than an empty cell. |
| Mercury, total (tHg) | 100 | government maximum level |
| Methylmercury (MeHg) | ≤ tHg | MeHg carries no product-specific sovereign cell; it is a component of and bounded by its parent total tHg (MeHg <= tHg), an enforceable ceiling via reflex speciation rather than an empty cell. |
| Nickel (Ni) | 10,000 | government maximum level |
| Tin (Sn) | 3,750,000 | European Union — human-food analog |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Aluminium (Al) | 560,000 | European Union — human-food analog |
| Total chromium (Cr) | 50 | AU — human-food analog |
| Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI) | 5 | European Union — human-food analog |

## 4 | Cite this standard

Pendergrass, K. (2026). *Hand soap (liquid and bar): HMTc standard* (Standard No. 10.83138/hmtc.std.14.hand-soap). Institute of Contaminant Standards. https://doi.org/10.83138/hmtc.std.14.hand-soap

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## References

[1] AU — human-food maximum levels
Binds Cr. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[2] European Union — human-food maximum levels
Binds Sn, Al, Cr-VI. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

### STATUS AND LICENCE

A normative certification standard, editorially reviewed and version-controlled in-house; every value traces to a named sovereign maximum level, disclosed in the derivation. © 2026 Institute of Contaminant Standards / Heavy Metal Certified. All rights reserved.

### COMPETING INTERESTS

This briefing is published by the Heavy Metal Tested & Certified (HMTc) program, operated by the Institute of Contaminant Standards. Its statements about government regulations, toxicology, and occurrence are sourced to the cited primary and expert-body records and to the independently maintained Heavy Metal Index; the program's own certification thresholds are not used as evidence for any factual claim made here.

### DATA AVAILABILITY

The works this reference draws on are listed in full in the references above and on the briefing page at https://heavymetalcertified.com/standards/hand-soap. Primary legal instruments and expert-body assessments are named with their public identifiers; the underlying occurrence and toxicology corpus is maintained on the Heavy Metal Index.

### PUBLICATION HISTORY

This revision 2026-08. The full dated record is maintained at https://heavymetalcertified.com/standards/hand-soap.